

present : points of similarity and of difference between the two religions, in spheres of thought which concern the deepest essentials, will sufficiently occupy our attention ; and in most of these points independence is so obvious that we shall not be troubled with suspicions of borrowing. Coincidences will be the independent agreement of deep thinkers upon the same great problems, and their independence will enhance their suggestiveness. Our line will resemble that of Professor Harnack in a striking paper in the *Hibbert Journal* for October 1911, in which he sketched the religion of Porphyry, showing in how many points it unconsciously resembled the faith which the philosopher in his controversial work so bitterly attacked. And at the other end of the scale of human thought we shall find an apt parallel in the coincidences which perpetually meet us as we study primitive religions in *The Golden Bough*. The human mind has an ultimate identity of constitution on many sides wherever we find it ; and when its powers are brought to bear upon identical material the results tend to approximate.

I must not further anticipate the promised moral, but proceed to sum up afresh some of the leading characteristics of Early Zoroastrianism in terms of a comparison with ideas found in the religion of Israel. By the religion of Israel I mean of course the religion in its full and complete development, including the crown of the whole system in the teaching of Jesus, and the apostolic interpretation of it. Indeed, as a main part of my subject is concerned with the phenomena of religious syncretism, it is reasonable to expect helpful illustration even from